

Class 10th | English



First Flight

AMANDA!

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. How old do you think Amanda is? How do you know this?

Ans. Amanda is a little, 8-12 years old school going girl.

We know this because of the reference of a mermaid and Rapunzel. Further, the instructions given to her for doing homework, nail biting, correcting posture, etc. are generally given to children of such age group.

QUESTIONS

2. Who do you think is speaking to her?

Ans. Any one of Amanda's elders or parents is speaking to her. From the instructions given to Amanda, one can say that it is most probably Amanda's mother or governess.

QUESTIONS

3. What could Amanda do if she were a mermaid?

Ans. If Amanda were a mermaid, she could be the only resident of the beautiful green sea where she would float in the soft waves of the sea. There, she could relax and enjoy her freedom.



QUESTIONS

4. Is Amanda an orphan? Why does she say so?

Ans. No, Amanda is not an orphan, though she wishes to be one.

She says so because she is upset at being scolded again and again by her mother. Thus, she thinks that if she had been an orphan, she would be free and her life would be peaceful.

QUESTIONS

5. Do you know the story of Rapunzel? Why does she want to be Rapunzel?

Ans. Rapunzel was a beautiful golden haired princess who lived in a tower. She had very long hair by which she used to allow people to come into her tower. Amanda believes that Rapunzel's life in the lonely tower would be very happy. So, she wanted to be Rapunzel and wishes to live in such a tower, away from everyone. She even imagines that in order to live a happy life she would never allow anyone to come into her tower.

QUESTIONS

6. What does the girl yearn for? What does this poem tell you about Amanda?

Ans. The girl Amanda yearns for freedom and peace in life.

According to the poem, Amanda feels that her freedom has been limited by her mother. She is fed up of the constant scolding and instructions by her mother. She wants to go away and live a peaceful life.

QUESTIONS

7. Which option completes the popular adage given below? _____ silence is gold.
- (a) Precious are words for
 - (b) Speech is silver
 - (c) Silver is the tongue
 - (d) Ideas may be precious but

QUESTIONS

Ans. (b) Speech is silver

QUESTIONS

- 8.** What causes acne to Amanda according to the speaker?
- (a)** Biting nails
 - (b)** Cleaning the room
 - (c)** Eating chocolates
 - (d)** Eating pizzas

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) Eating chocolates

QUESTIONS

- 9.** In the poem 'Amanda!', the speaker is so worried about acne. What does it show?
- (a)** This shows that importance is given to physical beauty.
 - (b)** This shows her concern towards Amanda.
 - (c)** This shows Amanda's carelessness.
 - (d)** Both (a) and (b)

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) This shows that importance is given to physical beauty.

QUESTIONS

- 10.** What do the words tranquil and rare signify?
- (a)** Pleasant surrounding
 - (b)** Freedom and peace
 - (c)** Music and excitement
 - (d)** Peace and no nagging

QUESTIONS

Ans. (d) Peace and no nagging

QUESTIONS

- 11.** Why has the poet used bracketed lines in the poem 'Amanda'.
- (a)** To show they are important
 - (b)** To show mother's words
 - (c)** To show Amanda's imagination
 - (d)** To show poet's words

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) To show Amanda's imagination

QUESTIONS

12. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Don't bite your nails, Amanda!
Don't hunch your shoulders, Amanda!
Stop that slouching and sit up straight,
Amanda!

H/W

QUESTIONS

i. Complete the sentence appropriately.

The purpose of the speaker's words in the given extract is to _____.

Ans. improve the listener's posture and habits

QUESTIONS

- ii. Select the option that fits with the following.
Slouching : Straight :: _____ : _____.

Ans. Lazy : Agile

QUESTIONS

iii. Alliteration is a literary device used in the extract.

Which of the following options does not include examples of this literary device?

- (a)** The moon and the shimmering stars watched over us.
- (b)** With that charming chat, Catherine choose comfort.
- (c)** Away ran the pathetic pooch pouting like a princess.
- (d)** Dee dee was driving down day after day.

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) The moon and the shimmering stars watched over us.

QUESTIONS

iv. What does the repetition of 'Amanda!' at the end of each line reflect?

Ans. The repetition of Amanda at the end of each line reflects the frustration of the speaker.

QUESTIONS

13. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

I thought I told you to clean your shoes,
 Amandal
 (I am an orphan, roaming the street.
 I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.
 The silence is golden; the freedom is sweet.)
 Don't eat that chocolate, Amandal (Amandal)

QUESTIONS

- i. Which of the following best describes the symbolic meaning of the soft dust and hushed, bare feet in Amanda's orphan daydream?
- (a) A sense of isolation and loneliness
 - (b) Freedom and independence
 - (c) Poverty and hardship
 - (d) Conformity and obedience

QUESTIONS

Ans. (b) Freedom and independence

QUESTIONS

- ii. What does the contrast between the speaker's commands and Amanda's daydream suggest about her imaginative escape? (Answer in 30-40 words)

Ans. The contrast between the speaker's commands and Amanda's daydream about her imaginative escape suggests the difference between their contrasting desires. In reality, Amanda is not given any freedom or peace. As a result, her imagination becomes her means of asserting her freedom, finding peace and resisting the limitations imposed by her reality. It serves as a coping mechanism and a form of rebellion against the constraints imposed on her.

QUESTIONS

- iii. Complete the following with the impact on the reader.
The lack of the special use of parentheses would have resulted in _____.

Ans. reduced importance of Amanda's daydreams resulting in the reader not recognising the contrast between the external commands and her inner thoughts.

QUESTIONS

iv. How does the line, "I thought I told you to clean your shoes, Amanda!" help us infer that Amanda's actions are being closely monitored and directed.

Ans. The use of the given line suggests a reminder / frustration on the part of the speaker, supporting the idea that Amanda's behaviour is under close scrutiny, This implies a relationship where Amanda is expected to adhere to specific instructions and fulfill assigned tasks, reinforcing a sense of external control and authority over her actions.

QUESTIONS

14. Why does Amanda wish to be a mermaid?

Ans. Amanda wishes to be a mermaid to live a life of freedom. She is constantly scolded by her mother. So, she escapes into her own world of imagination wherein she lives a peaceful life, all alone. As a mermaid she would be the sole resident of a beautiful sea.

QUESTIONS

15. How does the repeated use of the name 'Amanda' influence the overall tone of the poem?

Ans. The repeated use of the name 'Amanda' throughout the poem creates a sense of authority and control. The repetition conveys a commanding tone, as if someone in a position of authority, such as a parent, is speaking directly to Amanda. It also adds a sense of familiarity and intimacy to the tone. It suggests a close relationship ~~between~~ the speaker and Amanda, indicating that the instructions and restrictions come from a place of care and concern. Further, as the name 'Amanda' is repeated numerous times, followed by instructions or directions, it also creates a tone of frustration or annoyance.

QUESTIONS

16. What impression do you form about Amanda in the poem?

Ans. The poem tells us that Amanda is a young, restless girl with a vivid imagination. Even as she is being scolded by her mother, Amanda's mind wanders to imaginary scenarios where she is a mermaid, an orphan or Rapunzel. We also get to know that she is not granted any freedom and has no peace in her life as she is frustrated with the constant instructions that she gets.

QUESTIONS

17. How does Amanda tackle the nagging nature of her mother? Explain with examples from the poem.

Ans. In the poem, 'Amanda', the little girl named Amanda often escapes into her own world. Her world of dreams give her the freedom and peace that she seeks in reality where she is constantly nagged by her elders. Her mother continuously instructs and scolds her for her ill-manners and laziness. She is asked not to bite her nails, not to eat chocolates, to clean her room and so on. As Amanda's mother is giving her instructions, she is lost in her daydreams. The persistence of Amanda's mother leaves a harmful impression in her mind. Her retreat, then, is her way of tackling her mother. It is her shield and defence against the harsh realities that she goes through. In her reality, her freedom is restricted.

QUESTIONS

Her need for freedom and peace, finds expression in her dreams where she imagines a carefree and happy life as an orphan, mermaid and Rapunzel, without her mother. Amanda may seem moody and upset, to her mother, but is not really so. The nagging nature of her mother makes her escape into a world away from the realities of her life.

QUESTIONS

18. State the key points in the poem 'Amanda!'. What do you learn from it?

Ans. The key point highlighted in the poem 'Amanda!' is that every child is special in themselves and it requires a great amount of patience and love to make them understand this. To create such an understanding, parents must give freedom to their children as they learn the best from their own experiences. In this process, children may learn some bad habits which needs to be removed. This undoing also requires a great level of understanding and the right approach. Parents judging each action of a child does more harm. In the poem, Amanda goes through constant scoldings for her habits. Everything she does is corrected by her mother and she can't do anything at her will. Consequently, the girl seeks/desires.

QUESTIONS

The lack of freedom makes Amanda upset and moody as she escapes her world of imagination. She enjoys the things in her imagination which she is deprived of in reality. Therefore, in Amanda, we witness a failed approach of her parents and get the lesson that the parents need to take a more gentle/kind approach to teach their child.

QUESTIONS

19. Escapism is one way to run away from harsh realities. Discuss in the context of the poem 'Amanda!'.

Ans. It is true that escapism is one way to run away from harsh realities. By going through the whole poem, we come to know that Amanda's mother keeps instructing her all the time. Amanda's mother's intention may be to discipline the little girl and make her a mature person. But, children need love and a caring attitude in their elders. Advice in the form of nagging leaves a very harmful impression in the child's mind. The reality becomes harsh for them and they try to escape these realities by indulging in their own fantasy world. In this poem, Amanda's life is frustrating as she is forbidden to do anything without seeking permission. Continuous instructions of her mother and constant scoldings leave a very negative impact on a child's personality.

QUESTIONS

In such situation, Amanda adheres to a defence mechanism where she imagines herself to be free and without parents so that she is not nagged. She drifts into an imaginary situation to escape from the harsh realities of her life. It is the mother's behaviour that is forcing her to do so. Thus, parents need to understand that their child also requires a certain amount of freedom which must be given to them.

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